people. In specific episodes recounted later, such as the aftermath of the Partition in 1947 and the Bangladesh War of Independence in 1971, this figure had touched 10 million.

Among voluntary streams, marriage and movement with the household are important stated reasons of migration, amounting to over *300 million* people in India as per the Census of 2011, almost completely dominated by women in short-distance rural to rural movements. However, many of these migrations are also long-distance, especially from Bengal towards the north-west as the latter has very few females in the marriage market on account of strong norms such as preference for a son.[95] More women have moved permanently than men throughout Indian history due to the practice of village exogamy, and it is their connections and migrant links that constitute some of the major 'invisible threads' holding together Indian diversity.

Outside marriage migration, the Census of 2011 also revealed that nearly 10 million people had moved for educational purposes, mostly males and towards urban centres.[96] The data on pilgrimage is not directly available but the periodic Kumbh Mela attracts over 50 million people today, making it the largest human congregation to take place for a short period of time. Over 10 million Indians have moved abroad, primarily for work towards West Asia and North America, making India the world's largest recipient of international migrants' remittances.[97] Roughly the same number of people immigrated to India from Nepal and Bangladesh. Taking together the descendants of past emigrants, the size of the Indian international diaspora recently surpassed the 25 million mark. Correspondingly, in Chapter 4, I introduce the concept of internal diaspora based on language and conservatively estimate that figure to cross over 60 million.

Work-related migration is what most people associate 'migration' with. The Census of 2011 revealed that there were over 50 million internal migrants for economic reasons. The *Economic Survey of India* in 2017 estimated this figure to cross a 100 million when the limitations of the Census were fully taken into account.[98] That is, the migrant workforce has been conservatively estimated to comprise a fifth of India's total workforce.